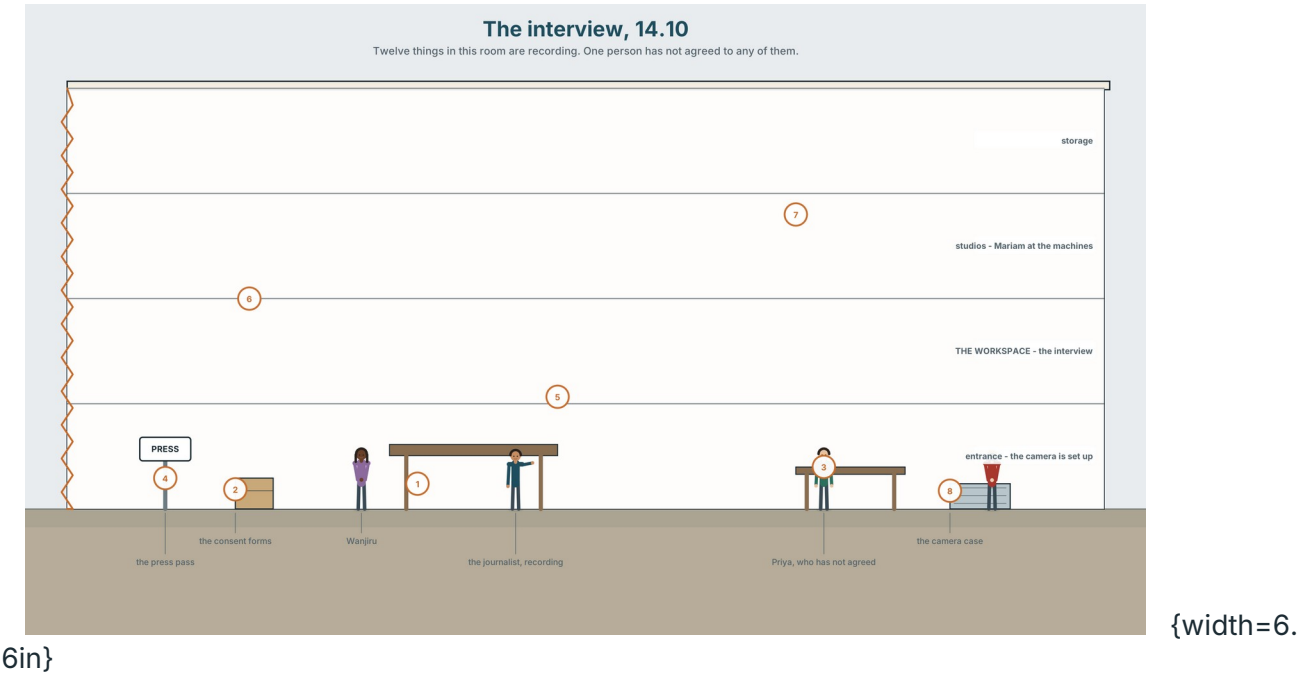


Table of Contents

B1.1 • Unit 9 • Whose Story

English Animated • Taking a Position • Jengo House, Nairobi Student's Book pages 168–187 • 20 pp • ~11.5 hours

Part 0 • The Big Picture ♦ A • THE WORLD



The interview, 14.10 — Twelve things in this room are recording. One person has not agreed to any of them.

Who gets to tell it?

By the end of this unit you will report the same event three times, for three audiences — and say which of the three you would put your name to.

♦ A • THE WORLD	How an account becomes a story, and what is lost at every retelling
♦ B • THE SYSTEM	The full range of reporting verbs • reported statements, returning • 24 words for witness and adaptation • 21 verbs that carry a judgement with them • stress on the reporting verb
♦ C • THE PERFORMANCE	Three accounts of one event, and a decision about which one is yours

0A • Find it

Twelve things being recorded in this picture. Four of these sixteen are not there.

a phone on a table · a notebook · a lanyard with a press pass · a voice recorder · a consent form · a camera · a tripod · a laptop · a whiteboard with names · a printed list · a signed release · a clip microphone · a boom pole · a lighting stand · a teleprompter · a studio clock

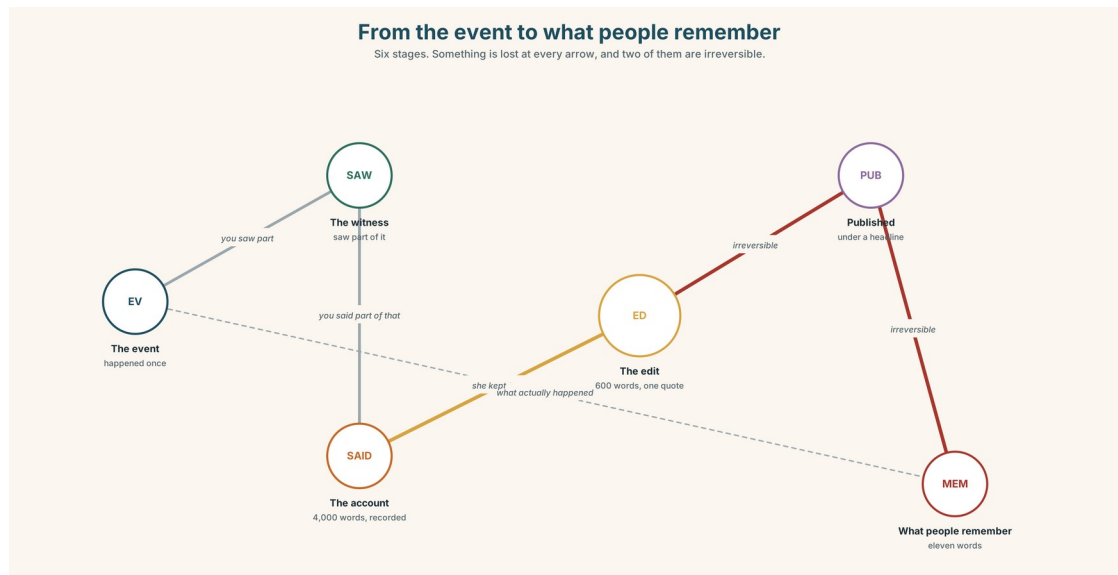
0B • Guess it

One person in this room has not agreed to be recorded. Which, and what tells you?

0C • Say it

Record thirty seconds. *Think of a story that was told about you. Who told it?* Unprepared.

Part 1 • Vocabulary Lab 1 B • THE SYSTEM



6in}

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From the event to what people remember — Six stages. Something is lost at every arrow, and two of them are irreversible.

1A • Meet — from event to story

Use the network. Name the word at each stage.

witness · account · testimony · version · angle · source · anonymity · adapt · dramatise · composite · disclaimer · hearsay

1B • Sort — cline of distance from the event

Order from **closest** to **furthest**.

what happened · what you saw · what you said you saw · what was written down · what was published · what people now remember

Mark where it stops being evidence.

1C • Sort — odd one out, and why

1. witness · source · testimony · hearsay
2. account · version · angle · composite
3. adapt · dramatise · disclaimer · composite
4. leave out · play down · write up · track down

1D • Stretch — the phrases

1. She said it **on the** _____, so it can be printed with her name.
2. He said it _____ **the record**, which means you may know it and not use it.
3. _____-**hand** evidence is what you saw yourself.
4. The paper gave him a **right of** _____ before publishing.
5. The film says it is **based on a** _____ **story**, which is not a claim about accuracy.
6. The scene never happened; that is **artistic** _____.
7. Her brother owns the building, which is a _____ **of interest**.

1E • Stretch — four phrasal verbs, one edit

leave out · play down · write up · track down

Two happen before the story exists. Two happen to it afterwards.

1F • The two sayings

that's not how it happened · whose story is it?

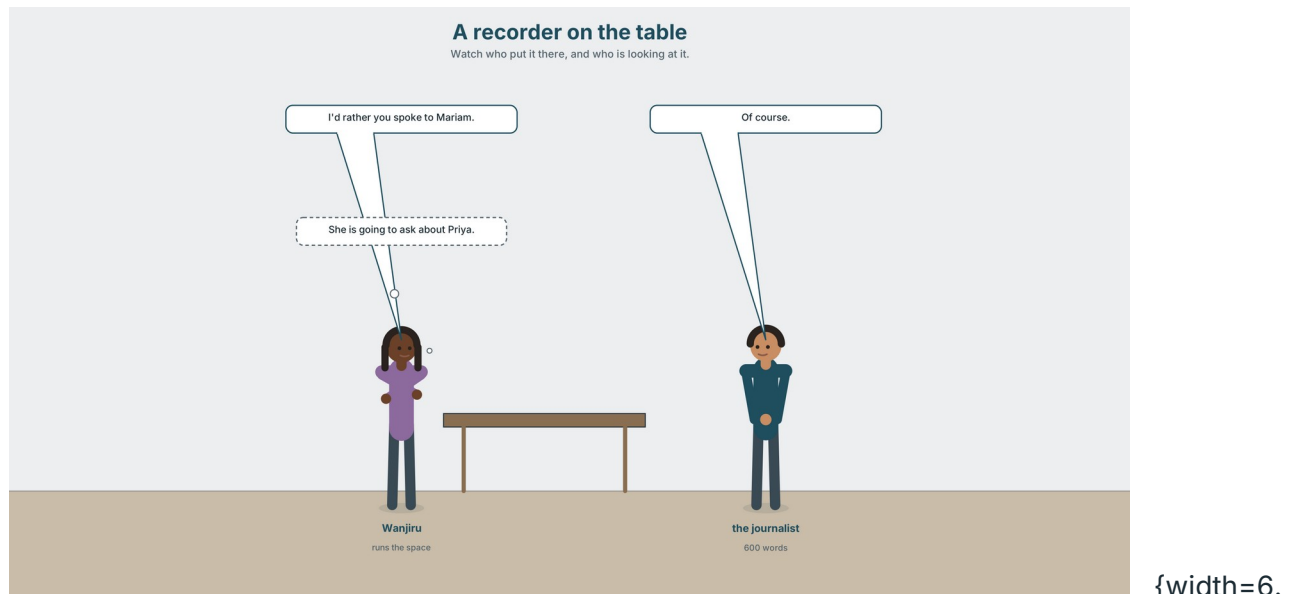
One is a correction. One is a claim of ownership. **Which does more damage in a meeting?**

Corpus Note *Claim* and *say* report the same words. In news writing, *claim* appears beside a following denial about four times as often as *say* does. The verb is doing the work before the reader reaches the evidence.

1G • Own it

Describe something that happened to you in two sentences. **Then describe it as somebody who dislikes you would.** Change no facts.

Part 2 • Listening ♦ A • THE WORLD



6in}

A recorder on the table — Watch who put it there, and who is looking at it.

2A • What she's actually here for 📻 Track 9.1

Before you listen. A journalist and Wanjiru, with a recorder on the table. **Who put it there?**

Gist — one listen, one question. What story has the journalist already decided to write?

Detail — complete the frame.

	What she asks about	What she keeps returning to
	the first five minutes	
	the last five minutes	

Inference. Wanjiru says "I'd rather you spoke to Mariam." **Why is she saying that, and does it work?**

Attitude. The journalist says "of course" three times. **Which one is agreement?**

Noticing. Six sentences. Sort them by what the reporting verb does to the claim.

1. She said the landlord had refused.
2. She claimed the landlord had refused.
3. She admitted the landlord had refused.
4. She insisted the landlord had refused.
5. She confirmed the landlord had refused.
6. She alleged the landlord had refused.

A. neutral • **B.** the writer doubts it • **C.** the claim costs the speaker something • **D.** it was already known

2B • Decoding clinic 📻 Track 9.2

Forty seconds. Four jobs.

- 1. Count the reporting verbs.
- 2. Which word is stressed in "she CLAIMED she didn't know"?
- 3. Catch the two dates.
- 4. said that — what happens to that?

Transcripts, page 179.

Part 3 • Grammar Lab 1 ♦ B • THE SYSTEM

Choosing the verb that reports

3A • Notice

Return to the six sentences. The reported words are identical in all six.

- 1. Which one is neutral?
- 2. Which two suggest the writer does not believe it?
- 3. In sentence 3, what does admitted tell you about the speaker's position?
- 4. In sentence 5, what does confirmed tell you about what the writer already knew?
- 5. A lawyer would object to one of these in a news report. Which, and why?

3B • See

Five things a reporting verb can do

The reported words do not change. The verb changes what the reader concludes.

the writer agrees	confirmed, pointed out	the writer already had it - this verifies
	admitted, conceded	it costs the speaker something to say
	said, told, stated, added	neutral. the writer takes no position
	maintained, insisted	the speaker is being contradicted and will not move
	claimed, purported	the writer is signalling doubt
	alleged	unproven, and legally the writer is not asserting it
the writer disagrees	denied, disputed, declined	the speaker pushed back

Change one verb and the reader concludes something different, with no reported word altered. It is an edit that leaves no fingerprint.

6in}

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Five things a reporting verb can do — The reported words do not change. The verb changes what the reader concludes.

3C • Know

Group	Verbs	What the writer is doing
neutral	say · tell · state · report ·	reporting, taking no

Group	Verbs	What the writer is doing
	add · note	position
doubting	claim · allege · maintain · purport	signalling distance from the claim
conceding	admit · concede · acknowledge · accept	the speaker said something against their own interest
confirming	confirm · recall · point out · stress	the writer already had it
refusing	deny · refuse · decline to comment · dispute	the speaker pushed back

And the pattern each takes:

admit / deny / recall + -ing or + that · refuse / claim + to + verb or + that · insist / stress / point out + that only

Watch out. *Admit* makes the speaker's own words costly to them. Using it where *say* would do is not neutral reporting — it is an edit with no fingerprint on it.

Why it matters. Change one verb and you have changed what the reader thinks, without changing a single reported word. This is the most powerful thing in this book and the hardest to see.

3D • Use — controlled

Choose the reporting verb. **More than one works in some; say what each would do.**

Wanjiru (1) _____ that the landlord had refused to pay. He (2) _____ ever having been asked. The inspector (3) _____ out that the report had been sent twice. Mariam (4) _____ that she had considered leaving, which she had not said publicly before. The managing agent (5) _____ to comment. The journalist (6) _____ that two tenants had contacted her first.

3E • Use — guided

Rewrite each sentence three times, with a neutral, a doubting and a conceding verb. **Then say which you would publish.**

1. "I didn't know the toilet was an issue."
2. "We offered to pay half."
3. "Nobody raised it with me."

3F • Use — open

Report the same thing to two people: somebody who will act on it, and somebody who will be upset by it. Your partner says which reporting verbs you used, and what they gave away.

3G • Check — six items

1. He _____ (deny) _____ (be) there at all.
2. She _____ (admit) that she _____ (not read) it.
3. They _____ (refuse) _____ (give) a reason.
4. He _____ (point) out that the lease _____ (expire) in March.
5. The agent _____ (decline) to comment.

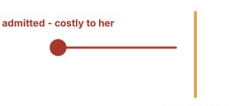
6. She _____ (insist) that nobody _____ (tell) her.

0-3 → Workbook pp. 70-72. 4-5 → Part 6. 6 → p. 179.

Why this sentence convicts somebody

✗ She admitted the toilet had never been built.

admitted - costly to her

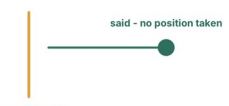


neutral / loaded

admitted tells the reader the speaker said something against her own interest. If she simply answered a question about a building she does not own, the verb has invented a confession.

✓ She said the toilet had never been built.

said - no position taken



neutral / loaded

said reports and claims nothing about the speaker. If the fact is damning, the reader can reach that themselves, which is the only version a correction cannot be demanded for.

What the writer thought:
The writer thought admitted was a more interesting word than said. It is a different claim, and it is a claim about the speaker, not the facts.

6in}

Why this sentence convicts somebody — Why this sentence convicts somebody

Part 4 • Speaking ♦ C • THE PERFORMANCE

4A • Fluency sprint — 4 / 3 / 2

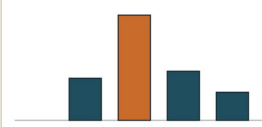
A story you have told more than once. Four minutes, three, two. **Notice what you have stopped saying.**

4B • The functional core — attributing and distancing

Two accounts of one afternoon
Learner A has one account. Learner B has the other. Find the real disagreement.

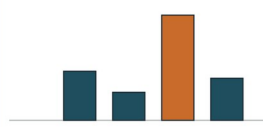
account one

the refusal came first



account two

the refusal came third



Describe only. Most of what looks like disagreement is not.
8 differences — find them all

6in}

Two accounts of one afternoon — Learner A has one account. Learner B has the other. Find the real disagreement.

Language Bank

attributing	<i>according to · she's quoted as saying · in her words</i>
distancing	<i>she claims · it's been suggested that · I can't verify this, but</i>
refusing to pass it on	<i>that's not mine to repeat · you'd have to ask her</i>
correcting	<i>that's not how it happened · the order is the other way round · I'd stress that nobody refused</i>

Information gap. Learner A has what one person said. Learner B has what another said. Neither sees the other. **Find out what they disagree about, and what they only appear to disagree about.**

4C • The performance — three tellings

Three audiences, two minutes each: **a friend · a committee · somebody who was there.** Same event. You may not change a fact.

4D • Observer

Listen for **one thing**: what appeared in two versions and not in the third?

4E • Two criteria

- ☐ Did I keep every fact the same? ☐ Could the person who was there recognise their own part?

Part 5 • Reading ♦ A • THE WORLD

5A • Predict

A personal essay called "**The quote I gave.**" The first line is:

I said eleven words to a journalist in 2019 and I have been described by them ever since.

What do you expect? One sentence.

5B • Skim — sixty seconds

Find the paragraph where the writer stops blaming the journalist.

The quote I gave

I said eleven words to a journalist in 2019 and I have been described by them ever since. The words were accurate. I said them. They are in my voice on her recording, and if I heard somebody else say them I would think exactly what everybody thought about me.

What I did not say, in the forty minutes either side of them, was the part that made them make sense. She did not leave it out to damage me. She left it out because it took two minutes to explain and the eleven words took four seconds, and she had six hundred words for the whole piece. I have since written to a length limit myself and I know what it does to you.

For about three years I told this story as something that was done to me. I was good at telling it. There is a version with a pause in it that gets a reaction.

The version is not honest, and I worked out why in an argument with somebody who had been in the room. She pointed out that I had chosen the eleven words. Not the edit — the words. I had reached for a phrase that was sharper than what I actually thought, because I was being recorded and because sharp phrases get agreed with. The journalist did not put a performance in my mouth. She printed one I had already given her.

That is a less comfortable story and it has no pause in it.

What I do now is simple and I recommend it without being certain it is right. I say the dull version first. If it is the only thing I say, it is the only thing that can be used. The cost is that I am quoted much less often, and that the people who are quoted instead are the people reaching for the sharp phrase, which is how the sharp phrase became the thing people believe.

5C • Close reading

1. How many words did the writer say, and how long was the piece?
2. Why does the writer say the journalist left out the context?
3. **What did the person who had been in the room point out?**
4. What does the writer mean by "a version with a pause in it"?
5. **What does the writer do now, and what is the stated cost?**
6. The last clause is an accusation against nobody in particular. **Who is it against?**

5D • Vocabulary in context

accurate · length limit · reach for (*reached for a phrase*) · performance · dull (*the dull version*)
· quoted

5E • The counter-text

The transcript, and the six hundred words

Everything printed is in the transcript. The transcript is four thousand words long.

AS PUBLISHED - 600 WORDS

...and look, the honest answer is that nobody was watching it. **"It was a shambles," admits former director** We were sort of people doing the work of nine and the reporting was ~~the four people doing the work of nine and the reporting was~~ ~~I have a shambles, I think it was a good one that if it had been~~ ~~at all times, Not the work - the paperwork is fine and I~~ would defend the work to anybody."

Words in transcript 4,100

What was cut

Words deleted

SENTENCE	IN TRANSCRIPT	PRINTED
"nobody was watching it"	yes	no
"four people doing the work of nine"	yes	no
"It was a shambles"	yes	YES
"Not the work - the paperwork"	yes	no
"I would defend the work to anybody"	yes	no

Nothing printed is inaccurate. The sentence that limits the quote - "Not the work, the paperwork" - follows it immediately in the recording and would have cost eleven words. The headline verb is admits. In the transcript he is answering a question he was asked.

- The sentence that makes it make sense
- 61 of 4,100 words - 1.5%
- "admits" in the headline. He was answering a question
- Four of the five sentences gone
- The one that survived is the shortest
- Eleven words would have changed the piece

6in}

The transcript, and the six hundred words — Everything printed is in the transcript. The transcript is four thousand words long.

Read the published piece and the full transcript extract, side by side.

1. How many words of the transcript survived into the piece?
2. **Which sentence in the transcript explains the quote, and where would it have gone?**
3. What reporting verb did the journalist use?
4. Find the sentence in the piece that is not in the transcript at all. **Where did it come from?**
5. **Was anything untrue printed?**

5F • Writer analysis

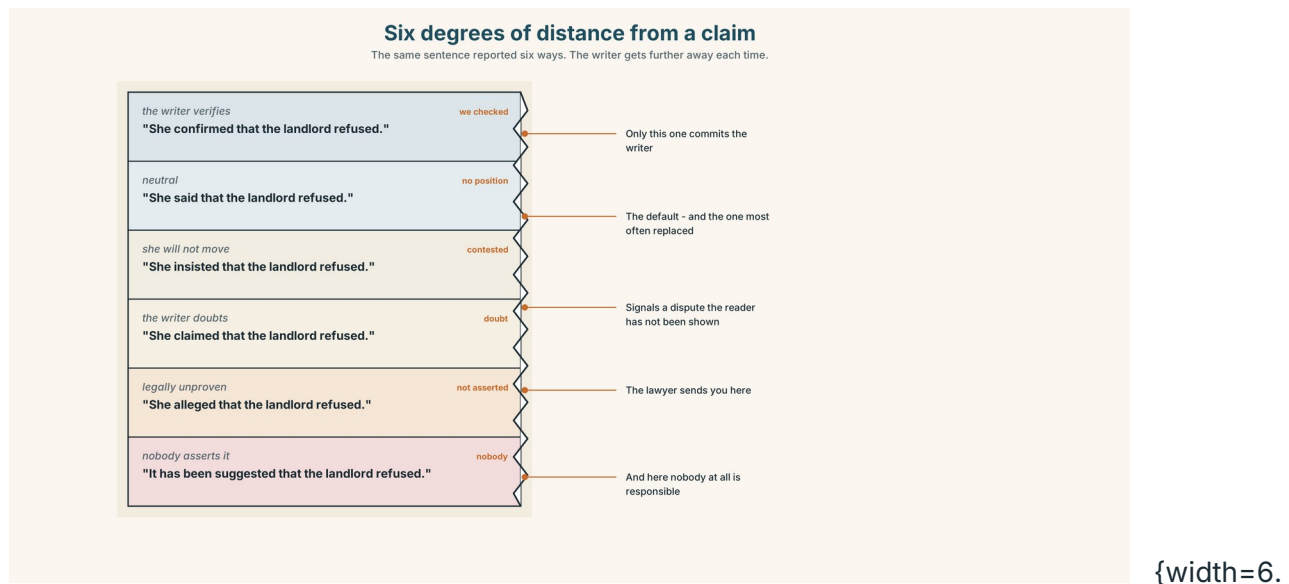
- The essay refuses an easy villain. **At what cost to the essay?**
- The piece is 600 words and the transcript is 4,000. **Is the essay's argument an argument against length limits, or against something else?**

5G • Text against text

The essay says the journalist printed a performance he had already given. The transcript shows him giving it. Two sentences on whether that settles it. The second begins *"What it does not settle is..."*

Part 6 • Vocabulary Lab 2 ♦ B • THE SYSTEM

Twenty-one verbs that judge while they report



6in}

Six degrees of distance from a claim — The same sentence reported six ways. The writer gets further away each time.

6A • Sort — what does the verb add?

Sort all twenty-one into five groups: **neutral • doubting • conceding • confirming • refusing.**

admit • deny • claim • insist • allege • concede • maintain • acknowledge • confirm • refuse • recall • stress • point out • go on to say • be quoted as saying • according to • put it another way • back up • stand by • words to that effect • no comment

6B • Chunk completion

1. She _____ her original statement under questioning.
2. He _____ it _____, saying the figure was closer to twelve.
3. The agent said "_____ " and put the phone down.
4. _____ the inspector, the report was sent twice.
5. He said he had been misled, or _____.

6C • Register sort

Which appear in a news report? Which in a court transcript? Which only in speech? **Four appear in all three.**

6D • Contrast Clinic — one claim, six verbs

Six items. The reported words do not change.

"The landlord refused to pay."

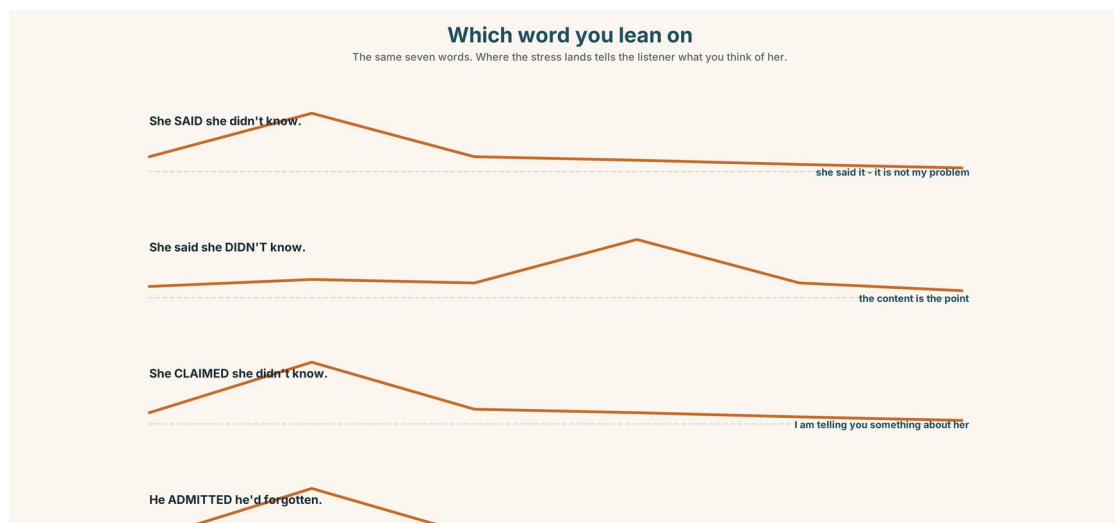
1. She _____ that the landlord refused to pay. (*neutral*)
2. She _____ that the landlord refused to pay. (*you doubt it*)

3. She _____ that the landlord refused to pay. (*it costs her to say so*)
4. She _____ that the landlord refused to pay. (*you already knew*)
5. She _____ that the landlord refused to pay. (*she is being contradicted and will not move*)
6. She _____ that the landlord refused to pay. (*legally unproven*)

Then: which one would a lawyer insist on, and why?

Part 7 • Pronunciation & Fluency Lab ♦ B • THE SYSTEM

Stressing the reporting verb



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6in}

Which word you lean on — The same seven words. Where the stress lands tells the listener what you think of her.

7A • Hear 🎧 Track 9.3

She **SAID** she didn't know. — (*she said it; whether it is true is not my problem*) She said she **DIDN'T** know. — (*the content is the point*) She **CLAIMED** she didn't know. — (*I am telling you something about her*)

7B • Say

Say all three. Your partner says what you think of her.

7C • Make it mean something

"He **admitted** he'd forgotten."

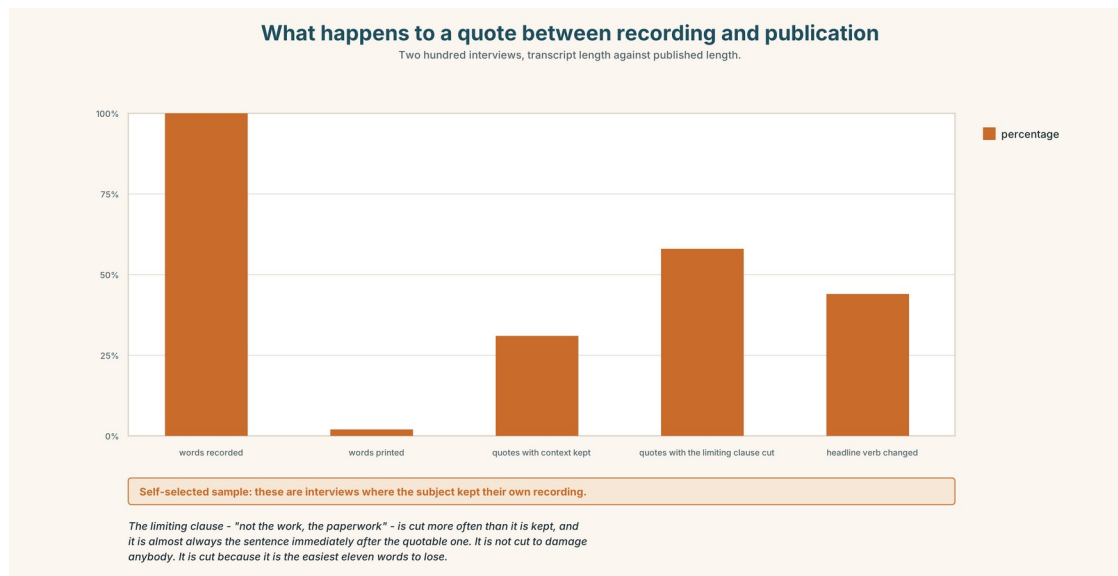
Stress **admitted**, then **forgotten**. One is sympathetic. One is not.

7D • Fluency 20 🟡

Twenty seconds: **report one thing three ways — neutral, doubting, conceding**. Three times.

Part 8 • Writing ♦ C • THE PERFORMANCE

The same event, for three readers • 140 words



{width=6.

6in}

What happens to a quote between recording and publication — Two hundred interviews, transcript length against published length.

8A • Read the model — three versions, one event

To a friend: *The landlord finally paid half. It took four months, an insurance letter and Priya leaving, and I'm not going to pretend I feel good about it.*

To the tenants' meeting: *The landlord has agreed to fund fifty per cent, following the insurer's query about the 2019 report. Works are scheduled for January. Obi obtained the quotes; the survey came in at 96,000 against an assumption of 160,000. [names, numbers, sequence. No feelings, and none implied]*

To the landlord: *Thank you for confirming the fifty per cent. I've attached the quotes and the survey. Obi will coordinate access with your contractor. We'll keep the invoice separate from the service charge, as agreed. [nothing about the four months. Nothing about the insurer]*

Questions about the writer's choices:

1. All three are true. **What is in the first that is in neither of the others?**
2. The second mentions the insurer. The third does not. **Why?**
3. **Which version would you be most comfortable having the other two readers see?**

8B • The anti-model

Following extensive discussions, agreement has been reached regarding the accessibility works. All parties have worked constructively and a positive outcome has been achieved for everyone involved.

Who does this version protect, and from what?

8C • Generate • 8D • Plan

the facts, listed • who each reader is • what each one will do with it • what each one does not need • what you would be ashamed to have hidden

8E • Draft — all three versions

8F • Peer review — two criteria

☐ Are all three factually identical? ☐ Is there anything in one that the others needed?

8G • The third criterion

Put your name on one of them. Which, and why that one?

Part 9 • The File ♦ A • THE WORLD + C • THE PERFORMANCE

CULTURE FILE • What's Funny Here?

Four jokes, four assumptions
Read them before the annotations. Mark the ones you merely understand.

FOUR THINGS PEOPLE FOUND FUNNY LAST YEAR	
1 A sign outside a cafe: "We do not have wifi. Talk to each other and pretend it is 1995." You need to know Travels	that cafes have wifi, and that 1995 is before it almost everywhere
2 "The meeting could have been an email. The email could have been a silence." You need to know Travels	the office complaint it is built on anywhere with meetings
3 A radio presenter, after a long government statement: "Well. There we are then." You need to know Travels	the statement, the presenter, and that the understatement is the whole joke badly - it is a tone, not a line
4 A note left on a shared fridge: "Whoever is taking the milk - I know it is you, Daniel." You need to know Travels	that there is a Daniel, and that everybody knows only inside the building

A fact, and a date. Both common
This one survives translation intact
A shared frustration, not a shared fact
A tone. You cannot translate a tone
Requires a specific person in a specific building
The best joke here travels least

{width=6.

6in}

Four jokes, four assumptions — Read them before the annotations. Mark the ones you merely understand.

9A • Four jokes

Four short pieces of humour, one from each of four places. **Which do you find funny, and which do you merely understand?** They are different experiences.

9B • What a joke assumes

For each: **what do you have to already know?** A fact, a person, a convention, a frustration? The ones that travel are rarely the ones with the best jokes in them.

9C • Your own

Bring something funny from your own language or context. **Explain what has to be known.** Then: is it still funny once explained?

9D • Humour that is not for you

Some jokes exclude by design. Some exclude by accident. **How do you tell, from inside and from outside?**

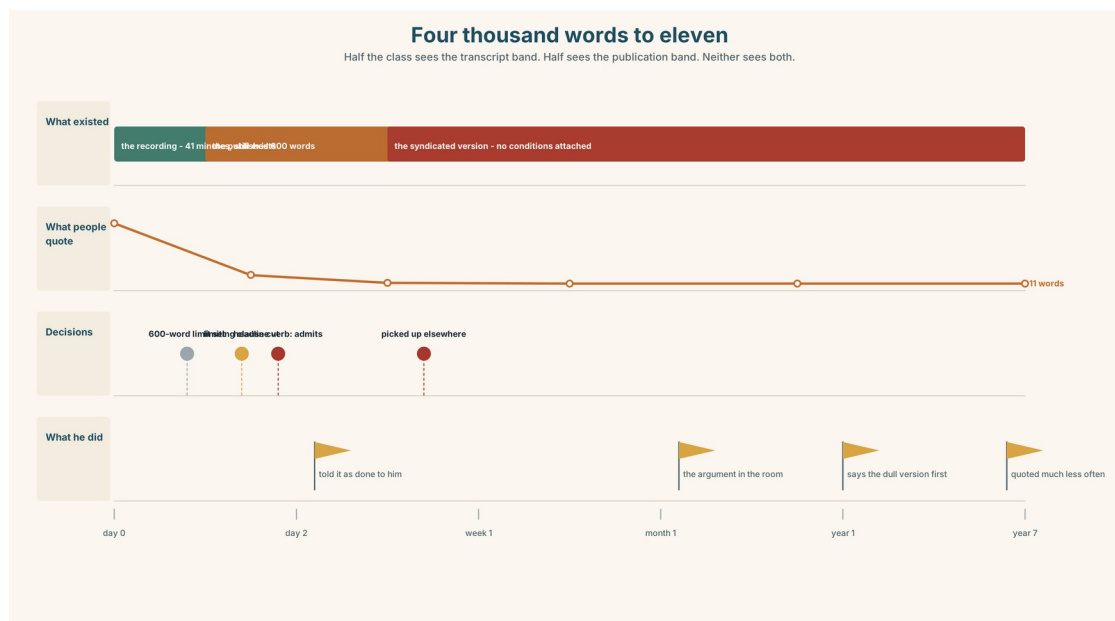
9E • The hard one

A story told about somebody gets a laugh in a meeting. **The person is in the room.** Write the sentence you would say — or defend saying nothing.

9F • Transfer

Watch something comic in English this week that you do not fully get. **Write down the exact moment you lost it.** That is the cultural boundary, located.

Part 10 • Mediation & Interaction ♦ C • THE PERFORMANCE



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6in}

Four thousand words to eleven — Half the class sees the transcript band. Half sees the publication band. Neither sees both.

10A • Relay

Half the class sees the transcript band; half sees the published band. Rebuild by speaking.

10B • Simplify

Explain the difference between *on the record*, *off the record* and *on background* to somebody about to speak to a journalist in twenty minutes.

10C • Compress

The essay into 60 words for somebody who has just been quoted badly. Defend three cuts.

10D • Online interaction

Write the reply to a post that has misreported something you said. **It has 400 shares.**

10E • Across languages

Report the same sentence in your language with a neutral verb and a doubting one. **Does your language carry the doubt in the verb, or somewhere else?**

Part 11 • The Decision ♦ C • THE PERFORMANCE

The profile

A journalist wants to write about Jengo House. She is good, the piece will be read, and two of the six tenants would benefit from it enormously.

The story she wants is about the accessible toilet: four months, an insurer, a landlord who moved only when his own money was at risk, and a woman who left before it was built.

Priya has not agreed to be named. She has not refused either. She has said *"I'd rather not be the reason."*

- **Do the piece with the story she wants.** Priya is central whether or not she is named — in a building of six people, "a tenant" is not anonymity.
- **Offer a different story** — the workspace, the economics, the survey that came in at 96,000. She will probably decline.
- **Refuse.** Keep the relationship, lose the coverage, and the story goes untold.

11A • The evidence

1. **The transcript and the published piece** from Part 5.
2. **The chart:** what happens to a quote between recording and publication.
3. **The voice.** Priya, thirty seconds: *"I'd rather not be the reason. I'm not saying don't. I'm saying I'd rather not be the reason."*

11B • Steelman

Argue the option you like least. Two minutes.

11C • Deliberate

I think they should _____, because _____. The strongest argument against me is _____, and my answer to it is _____.

11D • Decide — eighty words, two reasons

11E • Model decision

Go back to Priya and ask her the actual question, which nobody has asked her.

I am aware this is not one of the three options and that it delays everything by a week. It is the only move that does not decide something about her without her.

"I'd rather not be the reason" is not a refusal and treating it as consent is the thing this whole unit is about. It is also not an invitation to protect her by deciding for her, which is what refusing the piece would be. She is an adult with an interest in the building and in her own privacy, and she is the only person who can weigh them.

The question is not "may we name you". It is: "the piece will exist, you will be identifiable whether or not you are named, and here are the three versions. Which would you rather read about yourself?" That is a harder question and it is the honest one.

If she says no after that, refuse the piece and say why.

11F • The Reveal

What happened. They asked her. She thought about it for four days and said yes, named, on condition that the piece said she had left for a job and not because of the building — which was true, and which she had never said to anybody.

The piece ran. It was fair. Two sentences about her were lifted into a follow-up article elsewhere without the condition attached, and that version is the one that comes up when you search her name.

She has never mentioned it. Wanjiru found it eight months later.

They did the honest thing, and it was honest, and a second publication they had no contact with undid the only condition she asked for.

Was the reasoning sound? And: was there a version of this where that could not have happened?

Part 12 • Landing ♦ all three lines

12A • Recycle — twelve items

Six from this unit.

1. He ____ (deny) ____ (be) there at all.
2. She ____ out that the lease expired in March.
3. The agent ____ to comment.
4. She said it ____ the record, so it cannot be printed.
5. The film is based on a ____ story.
6. Her brother owns the building — a ____ of interest.

Four from Units 1–8.

7. The grower ____ I buy from has eleven acres. (*Unit 8 — can you drop it?*)
8. I want you ____ (check) it twice. (*Unit 7*)
9. The rule ____ (bring) in after a fire. (*Unit 6*)
10. If it ____ (be) up to me, I ____ (change) it. (*Unit 5*)

Two from Making Plans (A2.1).

11. She said she ____ (not receive) the letter. (*reported speech*)
12. The piece, ____ ran in March, was fair. (*relative clause*)

12B • Consolidate

120 words, one paragraph. Report one disputed event using at least six reporting verbs from Part 6, from at least three of the five groups.

12C • Can-do, with evidence

I can...	My evidence	Sure?
choose a reporting verb that says what I actually think of the claim	Part 3G score	☐ ☒ ☒
tell the same true story three ways for three readers	Part 8, all three	☐ ☒ ☒
recognise when humour assumes something I do not have	Part 9B	☐ ☒ ☒
decide about a story that is partly somebody else's	Part 11D	☐ ☒ ☒

12D • Replay

Part 0C again. Compare.

12E • Glossary — forty-five items, as a map

THE EVENT · witness · account · testimony · first-hand · hearsay · source **THE STORY** · version · angle · adapt · dramatise · composite · based on a true story · artistic licence **THE RULES** · on the record · off the record · right of reply · anonymity · a conflict of interest · disclaimer **EDITING** · leave out · play down · write up · track down **NEUTRAL** · say · tell · add · note · according to · be quoted as saying · go on to say **DOUBTING** · claim · allege · maintain **CONCEDING** · admit · concede · acknowledge **CONFIRMING** · confirm · recall · point out · stress · back up · stand by **REFUSING** · deny · refuse · no comment · words to that effect · put it another way **SAYINGS** · that's not how it happened · whose story is it?

12F • Next

Unit 10 • What is a fair day's work?